

EAM310 · EAM DIAGNOSIS I · VUIM · SUMMER 2026

Drill Pack

Blind ID · Rate Trainer · Probes · Fluency · Error Log

Prof. Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac.

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Jonathan Centeno · D.AcHM Candidate · VUIM 2026–2030

TCM for Ballroom Dancers | Dance Medicine Specialty

How drilling differs from studying

Reading builds understanding. Drilling builds **speed**. You can understand all 28 and still blank under time pressure — these three drills fix that. Fifteen minutes daily beats two hours on Sunday, and that's not a motivational claim, it's how the effect works.

PART A · Blind ID — All 28, Both Directions

How to run this drill

Cover the right column. Read the description, name the pulse and its indication out loud, then uncover. Target: 28/28 in under 4 minutes, twice consecutively.

Description (cover the right)	Answer
1. Felt distinctly at the superficial depth; force decreases slightly deeper but never feels empty. — <i>Wood floating on the surface of water; a subtle breeze across a bird's back; scallion leaves rolled lightly between the fingers.</i>	Floating 浮 Fú Invasion of external Wind. Yin Deficiency (interior condition presenting superficially).
2. Located deep next to the bone; barely felt with light or moderate pressure; only felt pressing to bone and tendons. — <i>A stone thrown into a well, sinking to the bottom.</i>	Deep / Submerged 沉 Chén Pathogenic factor in the Interior (Deep-Full). Yang Deficiency (Deep-Weak).
3. Fewer than three beats per breath, about 40–60bpm, regular rhythm.	Slow 遲 Chí Cold pattern. Empty-Cold (Slow+Weak). Full-Cold (Slow+Full).
4. Over five beats per breath, 90–140bpm, regular rhythm.	Rapid 數 Shuò Heat pattern. Full-Heat (Rapid+Full). Empty-Heat (Rapid+Floating-Empty).
5. Wide but without strength; forceless at all three positions under light or heavy pressure; a sense of emptiness. — <i>A water balloon — big on the outside, nothing solid when you press in.</i>	Empty / Deficient 虛 Xū Qi Deficiency.
6. Felt at all three positions and all three depths; long, wide, and forceful.	Full / Excessive 實 Shí Full pattern. Full-Heat (Full+Rapid). Full-Cold (Full+Slow).
7. Feels quick though not rapid; slippery and smooth; rounded inside the vessel, as if oily. — <i>A pearl rolling on a plate; a raindrop gliding off a leaf.</i>	Slippery 滑 Huá Phlegm. Dampness. Retention of food. Pregnancy.
8. Seems slow and is not smooth; vessel is thin; rhythm irregular in force and fullness; feels rough, jagged. — <i>Scraping bamboo with a small knife.</i>	Choppy 澀 Sè Blood Deficiency. Exhaustion of Body Fluids.
9. Smooth and straight; felt extending distally and proximally beyond the usual positions.	Long 長 Cháng Heat patterns.

Description (cover the right)	Answer
10. Cannot be felt in all three positions; absent at the distal and/or proximal position.	Short 短 Duǎn Severe Qi Deficiency. Stomach-Qi Deficiency.
11. Wide and forceful, though it fades gently; vessel wide and thick. — <i>Ocean waves that come strongly but leave calmly.</i>	Overflowing / Flooding 洪 Hóng Full-Heat. Empty-Heat (Overflowing-Empty).
12. Very thin, like a fine thread, but distinct and clear without interruption of rhythm under pressure. — <i>Angel-hair pasta rather than a thick udon noodle.</i>	Fine / Thin 細 Xì Blood Deficiency. Dampness with severe Qi Deficiency.
13. Extremely thin and forceless; seems felt, then not felt; pressing deeply the vessel becomes vague. — <i>Now you see it, now you don't.</i>	Minute / Faint 微 Wēi Severe deficiency of Qi and Blood.
14. Rises and falls with strength, vibrating left and right; feels twisted like a thick rope. — <i>Fingers on a highly stretched twisted cord, snapping back and forth.</i>	Tight 緊 Jǐn Cold — Exterior (Tight-Floating), Interior Full-Cold (Tight-Full-Deep), Interior Empty-Cold (Tight-Weak-Deep). Pain.
15. Taut, long, and forceful whether pressed or not; maintains a straight line beneath the fingers. — <i>A spring stretched on a musical instrument; a guitar string about to snap.</i>	Wiry 弦 Xián Liver disharmony. Pain. Phlegm.
16. Beats four times per breath — faster than the Slow pulse.	Slowed-Down / Moderate 緩 Huǎn Generally a HEALTHY pulse — the one qualitatively normal entry on this list.
17. Wide and soft when touched lightly, hollow when seeking; edges clearly felt under pressure but the center is obscure. — <i>A scallion stalk — has an edge but is hollow inside.</i>	Hollow 芤 Kōu Hemorrhage. Forthcoming hemorrhage (Hollow+Rapid). Yin Deficiency.
18. Large, thick, and wide; rapid and forceful when lightly touched, but hollow when pressed deeply. — <i>The surface of a drum — thick on top, hollow beneath.</i>	Leather 革 Gé Severe Kidney-Essence Deficiency. Severe Kidney-Yin Deficiency.
19. Deep, taut, long, wide, and forceful; deeply located, cannot be felt with light or moderate pressure.	Firm / Confined 牢 Láo Blood Stasis. Interior Cold (Firm+Slow). Pain.
20. Superficial, thin, and forceless; grows weaker and weaker the more it is pressed. — <i>A strand of cotton floating on water; a bubble that bursts under light pressure.</i>	Soggy 濡 Rú Dampness with Qi Deficiency. Yin Deficiency. Essence Deficiency.
21. Forceless, deep, and thin; only felt at the deep level by pressing; lost entirely with more pressure.	Weak / Frail 弱 Ruò Yang Deficiency. Blood Deficiency.
22. Wide, superficial, forceless, and slack when touched lightly; indistinct; disappears under pressure, rate hard to count. — <i>Flower blossoms lightly scattering to the ground.</i>	Scattered 散 Sǎn Severe Qi and Blood Deficiency. Severe Kidney-Qi Deficiency. A serious condition.
23. Cannot be felt touching, seeking, or pressing — only felt pressing very heavily to the bone. — <i>Pulsation seeming to come from beneath the bone and tendons.</i>	Hidden 伏 Fú Severe Yang Deficiency.

Description (cover the right)	Answer
24. Rapid and slippery; forceful specifically at the middle portion. — <i>A bean bouncing in the vessel — well-defined peaks, no head or tail.</i>	Moving 動 Dòng Shock, anxiety, fright. Pain.
25. Beats rapidly with irregular, random stops. — <i>Agitated and urgent, like a man running and suddenly falling down.</i>	Hasty 促 Cù Severe Heat. Deficiency of Heart-Qi. Heart-Fire.
26. Slow with irregularly missed beats; the pulse resumes immediately after the missed beat.	Knotted 結 Jié Cold with Heart-Yang Deficiency.
27. Pauses at REGULAR intervals; resumes after the pause.	Intermittent 代 Dài Serious problem in the internal organs. Heart problem (Western medical sense).
28. Rapid, beating more than seven times per breath (140–180bpm) — an extreme version of Rapid; rhythm stays regular.	Hurried / Racing 疾 Jí Fire exhausting Yin.

Round 2 — Reverse the drill

Cover the LEFT column instead. Read the pulse name and produce the sensation, classical image, and indication from memory. This direction is harder and is what exam vignettes actually require.

PART B · Rate Trainer — The Slow/Huǎn Killer

The one thing paper can't teach you — so here's the workaround

Rate is the single most testable pulse parameter and the easiest to get wrong, because it depends on **your own breath** as the ruler. This sheet trains that ruler using a phone metronome, so that 'under three' and 'four' and 'over five' become things you recognise instantly.

1 The Conversions You Need Cold

Beats per YOUR breath	Approx. bpm	Name	Meaning
Under 3	40–60	Slow 遲 Chí	Cold pattern
4	~60–75	Slowed-Down / Moderate 緩 Huǎn	Generally HEALTHY
4–5	60–90	Normal	The reference range
Over 5	90–140	Rapid 數 Shuò	Heat pattern
Over 7	140–180	Hurried / Racing 疾 Jí	Fire exhausting Yin

The trap this sheet exists to kill

Slow is under 3. Huǎn is 4. One is a Cold pattern; the other is a healthy person. If you are eyeballing rather than counting, these are indistinguishable — and Huǎn is the only qualitatively normal pulse among the 28.

2 Calibrating Your Own Breath

There is no prescribed second-count — deliberately

Asked how many seconds a breath should be, Schrier's answer was essentially: breathe naturally, don't engineer it. If you force slow or force fast you corrupt your own ruler. But you should **know** roughly what your natural breath is, so you can convert to bpm when you need to.

Step	Do this
1	Sit. Breathe normally for a minute without counting. Don't manage it.
2	Now count your breaths for 60 seconds without changing them. Record the number.
3	Your breath length $\approx 60 \div$ that number, in seconds.
4	Your personal conversion: $\text{bpm} \approx (\text{beats per breath}) \times (\text{breaths per minute})$.

Attempt	Date	Breaths per minute	My breath length (sec)	bpm per 1 beat/breath
1				
2				
3				

3 Metronome Drill

Setup

Any metronome app. Set your breath as the bar — if your natural breath is ~5 seconds, that's 12 breaths/min. Then set the metronome to the bpm values below and practise **counting beats per breath** until you can name the category without arithmetic.

Set metronome to	You should feel	Say
50 bpm	Clearly under 3 per breath	"Slow"
65 bpm	About 4 per breath	"Huǎn — healthy"
80 bpm	4–5 per breath	"Normal"
110 bpm	Over 5 per breath	"Rapid"
150 bpm	Over 7 per breath	"Hurried / Racing"

Then randomise

Have someone set the metronome without telling you, or shuffle the five values. Name the category before you count consciously. That instant categorisation is the actual skill — counting is the backup.

4 Drill Log

Date	Values tested	Correct / 5	Which one I miss most	Notes

5 Rhythm — The Second Half of Rate

Rate alone doesn't separate the irregular three

Once you can categorise speed, add the pause pattern. Set a metronome and manually skip beats to simulate each:

Simulate	Speed	Pause pattern	= Pulse	Indicates
Skip beats randomly at 50bpm	Slow	Random, resumes immediately	Knotted 結	Cold with Heart-Yang Deficiency
Skip beats randomly at 110bpm	Rapid	Random	Hasty 促	Severe Heat · Heart-Fire · Heart-Qi Def
Skip every 4th beat, consistently	Either	Regular intervals	Intermittent 代	Serious organ / Heart problem — most serious
Steady, no skips, 150bpm	Very rapid	None — regular	Hurried/Racing 疾	Fire exhausting Yin

6 Tap Grid — Mark What You Hear

Use this while the metronome runs

One row per trial. Mark a dot for each beat, a gap for each pause. Then name it.

Sixteen beat cells per row · last column = your call (Slow / Huǎn / Normal / Rapid / Knotted / Hasty / Intermittent / Racing)

You have an advantage here

Beats per bar, tempo recognition, and catching a dropped beat are things you already do. American Rhythm tempos run roughly 96–128 bpm depending on the dance — that range spans the Normal/Rapid boundary almost exactly. Use tempos you already know by feel as your reference points.

PART C · Micro-Probes — Spaced Retrieval

Why ten small probes instead of one big quiz

Frequent, low-stakes probing beats a single high-stakes block for retention and for anxiety. Each probe is 3 items and should take under 90 seconds. Do one per sitting, spaced across the week — not all ten at once.

Scoring

3/3 → space it out 3 days. 2/3 → repeat tomorrow. 0–1/3 → back to the Workbook section, then re-probe same day.

1 Probe 1 — Positions

1. Left Cùn organs?

2. Right Chǐ organs?

3. Which burner does Guān reflect?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

2 Probe 2 — Method

1. Movement that checks shape?

2. Movement that checks length?

3. Whose breath sets the rate?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

3 Probe 3 — Normal

1. 胃 Wèi means?

2. 根 Gēn is felt where?

3. Normal bpm range?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

4 Probe 4 — Seasonal

1. Summer pulse + dates?

2. Winter pulse + dates?

3. When is a seasonal pulse abnormal?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

5 Probe 5 — Floating family

1. Floating + Tight?

2. Floating + Rapid?

3. Floating + Empty — two options and the differentiator?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

6 Probe 6 — Deep family

1. Deep + Slow?

2. Deep + Weak?

3. Deep + Wiry?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

7 Probe 7 — Rhythm

1. Knotted — speed and pause type?

2. Hasty — speed and pause type?

3. Intermittent — pause type and why it matters most?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

8 Probe 8 — Look-alikes

1. Fine vs. Minute?

2. Hollow vs. Leather?

3. Soggy vs. Weak?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

9 Probe 9 — Classical images

1. Pearl on a plate?

2. Scraping bamboo?

3. Blossoms scattering?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

10 Probe 10 — Disposition

1. Which rhythm finding warrants referral?

2. What does Hasty+Fine-without-strength indicate?

3. Flooding in winter means?

Score: ☐ 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 Date: _____ Next probe: _____

11 Probe Tracker

Probe	Attempt 1	Date	Attempt 2	Date	Attempt 3	Date
Probe 1						
Probe 2						
Probe 3						
Probe 4						
Probe 5						
Probe 6						
Probe 7						
Probe 8						
Probe 9						
Probe 10						

PART D · Fluency Timings

SAFMEDS — Say All Fast, a Minute Every Day, Shuffled

Accuracy is not the goal; **rate** is. You already know these if you can say them slowly. Fluency means saying them fast enough that recall costs you nothing under exam pressure.

How to run it

Shuffle your Anki cards (or the Blind ID Drill). Set a timer for 60 seconds. See card → say answer aloud → next. Don't correct mid-timing. Count correct and incorrect at the end. Chart it. One minute a day beats an hour on Sunday.

1 Aim Rates

Deck	Beginning	Developing	Fluent (aim)
Pulse name → indication	10–15/min	20–30/min	40+/min
Classical image → pulse name	8–12/min	18–25/min	35+/min
Combination → meaning	6–10/min	15–22/min	30+/min
Positions & seasonal	12–18/min	25–35/min	45+/min

2 Daily Timing Log

[illegible]

3 Celeration Chart

Plot correct-per-minute daily

Y-axis: count. X-axis: day. Draw your trend line. The line matters more than any single day — a flat line means change the practice, not the effort.

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Y-axis: count. X-axis: day. Draw your trend line. The line matters more than any single day — a flat line means change the practice, not the effort.

[illegible]

Day 1 · 5 · 10 · 15 · 20 · 25 · 30

PART E • Error-Correction Log

The loop

Miss → immediate correct model → re-probe same session → space it. An error you look at once and move past is an error you will make again on the exam.

The loop

Miss → immediate correct model → re-probe same session → space it. An error you look at once and move past is an error you will make again on the exam.

Step	Do this	Not this
1. Miss	Note the exact item you got wrong	"I sort of knew it"
2. Model	Write the correct answer in full , from the source	Just read it
3. Re-probe	Cover it. Reproduce it. Same session.	Assume it stuck
4. Space	Re-test at +1 day, +3 days, +7 days	One and done

1 Error Log

#1 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

#2 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

#3 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

#4 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

#5 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

#6 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

#7 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

#8 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

#9 Source (quiz/probe/drill): _____ Date: _____

Item I missed:

Correct answer, written out in full:

Why I missed it (confused with / never learned / blanked):

Re-probed same session: ☐ +1d ☐ +3d ☐ +7d ☐

2 Error Pattern Review

Do this weekly

Read back your log. Are your errors clustered? Most students find 80% of misses fall into 2–3 confusion pairs. If yours cluster, stop general review and drill only that cluster — that is where the marks are.

Cluster I keep missing	How many times	Targeted fix